

DOMINION BUREAU OF STATISTICS

HEALTH AND WELFARE DIVISION

Summary of Cases of Notifiable Diseases in Canada, as reported by the Provincial Health Departments

for the week endedDecember 22,..... 1956, in comparison with the previous week¹, and the 5-year (1951-55) Median

No.	DISEASE	CANADA ²						NFLD.			P.E.I.			N.S.			N.B.			QUE.			ONT.			MAN.			SASK.			ALTA.			B.C.			No.
		Report Week	Previous Week	Median 1951-55	Cumulative Total ³			Report Week	Previous Week	Median 1951-55	Report Week	Previous Week	Median 1951-55	Report Week	Previous Week	Median 1951-55	Report Week	Previous Week	Median 1951-55	Report Week	Previous Week	Median 1951-55	Report Week	Previous Week	Median 1951-55	Report Week	Previous Week	Median 1951-55	Report Week	Previous Week	Median 1951-55	Report Week	Previous Week	Median 1951-55				
					1956	1955	Median 1951-55																															
1	Chickenpox	519	1,364	949	35,467	32,871	44,937	-	-	4	-	5	1	43	78	15	..	..	..	220	638	197	-	438	548	45	48	42	..	..	39	..	..	11	211	157	92	1
2	Diphtheria	2	2	8	136	136	184	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	2	3	-	-	-	-	-	-	2	-	-	1	-	-	-	-	2	
3	Dysentery: ⁴	4	4	12	617	669	669	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	4	..	..	..	..	2	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	4	4	3	
4	(a) Amoebic	-	-	-	2	3	18	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	..	..	..	..	..	..	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	4	
5	(b) Bacillary	4	4	6	614	666	666	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	4	..	..	..	..	1	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	4	4	5	
6	Encephalitis, infectious	-	1	-	46	35	41	-	-	-	..	..	..	-	-	-	-	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1	-	6
7	Influenza, epidemic	28	121	48	10,882	38,244	10,093	..	..	..	22	50	-	5	71	13	..	..	..	-	-	-	-	-	-	1	-	1	-	-	-	..	..	..	-	-	-	7
8	Measles	806	1,542	869	52,275	56,137	56,137	-	-	31	..	1	..	35	10	100	..	..	3	322	881	155	-	258	267	40	53	42	..	..	9	107	115	53	302	224	130	8
9	Meningitis, meningococcal	2	5	6	279	298	292	1	3	-	-	-	1	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1	1	-	-	-	2	-	..	..	..	-	-	-	1	9
10	Mumps	478	778	530	27,192	26,616	34,584	-	-	-	4	..	..	12	45	8	..	..	..	132	222	70	-	231	319	22	17	36	..	..	12	..	..	3	308	263	75	10
11	Poliomyelitis, epidemic: ⁴	2	5	18	611	1,012	2,536	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1	1	-	-	2	1	-	1	2	-	-	-	-	1	1	1	-	2	11
12	(a) With paralysis	1	2	11	358	544	1,155	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1	1	-	-	-	-	-	1	1	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	2	12
13	(b) Without paralysis	1	3	3	205	375	1,292	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	2	1	-	-	1	-	-	-	-	-	1	-	-	-	13
14	Rubella	231	372	77	51,983	20,085	10,064	-	-	-	..	..	..	-	-	1	..	..	..	48	135	4	-	37	28	4	-	1	..	..	4	90	44	13	89	156	8	14
15	Scarlet fever, etc. ⁵	94	242	295	11,441	9,159	14,143	1	7	4	6	19	5	12	38	5	-	1	2	46	90	42	-	38	90	1	4	7	7	3	31	14	31	29	7	11	27	15
16	Smallpox	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	..	..	..	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	16
17	Tuberculosis: ⁴	166	244	149	9,094	10,062	10,344	10	9	3	1	-	-	-	-	-	9	13	6	79	125	44	-	18	16	16	19	11	5	8	4	20	29	16	26	23	30	17
18	(a) Pulmonary	158	219	123	7,501	8,004	8,390	10	9	2	-	-	-	-	-	-	9	12	6	78	123	42	(6)	(6)	(6)	16	19	11	4	6	3	20	28	16	21	22	24	18
19	(b) Non-pulmonary	8	7	8	504	583	543	-	-	1	1	-	-	-	-	-	-	1	-	1	2	2	(6)	(6)	(6)	-	-	-	1	2	1	-	1	-	5	1	3	19
20	Typhoid and paratyphoid	5	11	5	450	372	459	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	2	-	4	7	1	-	2	1	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1	-	-	20
21	Undulant fever	1	3	1	138	120	131	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	..	3	1	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	..	..	..	1	-	-	21
22	Venereal diseases:	264	311	250	16,540	16,417	17,953	2	10	2	4	-	-	2	8	8	1	1	1	66	45	31	-	53	44	28	31	24	28	20	23	43	70	35	90	73	43	22
23	(a) Syphilis, primary	1	4	2	113	125	198	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1	-	-	-	1	4	-	-	-	1	-	-	-	23
24	(b) " secondary	1	-	1	54	49	108	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	24
25	(c) " other	21	36	31	1,899	2,199	2,556	-	1	1	-	-	-	-	2	1	1	-	-	12	20	9	-	10	8	3	2	1	1	-	1	-	-	2	4	1	3	25
26	(d) Gonorrhoea	240	271	218	14,462	14,022	14,266	2	9	2	4	-	-	2	6	7	-	1	-	54	25	24	-	43	38	25	29	23	25	16	16	42	70	32	86	72	42	26
27	(e) Other venereal diseases ⁷	1	-	-	12	22	22	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1	-	-	-	-	-	-	27
28	Whooping cough	99	319	109	8,650	13,521	9,277	-	-	-	3	2	1	-	-	2	2	-	-	76	242	49	-	34	31	2	2	2	2	10	11	2	14	9	12	15	8	28

(1) Figures adjusted for delayed reports. (2) Exclusive of Yukon and Northwest Territories. (3) Total accumulated to the end of the current week from the first week ending in January of the year stated. (4) Includes cases where type was not specified. (5) Scarlet fever includes cases of streptococcal sore throat; streptococcal sore throat not reportable in New Brunswick and Quebec. (6) Type not specified. (7) Includes chancroid, granuloma inguinale and lymphogranuloma venereum. .. Not reportable. (8) Includes mostly delayed cases. (9) Report not received.

THE SITUATION IN THE UNITED STATES (Source: "MORBIDITY AND MORTALITY-WEEKLY REPORT", U.S. National Office of Vital Statistics): Number of reported cases for the current week (previous week in parentheses):

Diphtheria 23 (62); Measles 3,927 (3,875); Meningitis, other 23 (50); Poliomyelitis, with paralysis 33 (53); Smallpox - (-); Undulant fever 19 (21); Encephalitis infectious 16 (26); Meningococcal infections 43 (49); Poliomyelitis, acute 66 (100); Poliomyelitis, without paralysis 16 (26); Typhoid fever 15 (23);

The incidence of poliomyelitis in 1956 continues to be lower than in 1955, and also lower than for any other year since 1947. The 47.5 per cent reduction in number of cases for the first 50 weeks in 1956 as compared with the same period in 1955 is about twice as great as the reduction between 1954 and 1955. The proportions of paralytic, non-paralytic, and unspecified cases of the disease shown in the provisional weekly reports were quite different in 1956 as compared with 1955. For 1956, the percentages were 43.5, 38.3, and 18.2, respectively; and for 1955 they were 36.2, 38.1, and 25.8, respectively. The smaller proportions of non-paralytic and unspecified cases for the present year probably are due in part to differences in reporting by physicians, that is, more accurate judgment of the type of disease when the report was made. Not all states reported a reduction in number of cases in 1956 as compared with 1955. Nine states reported increases varying from about 5 to 174 per cent. The nine were distributed equally among the north central, southern, and far western sections of the country.

EPIDEMIC REPORTS: Streptococcal sore throat - Nfld. reports mild epidemic at Port de Grave and Harbour Main.
Influenza - Nfld. reports epidemic at St. Lawrence.